

does this for you. The *Django Admin* is a customizable, web-based interface that allows you to create and modify your `Model` objects with very little code.

Figure 5.1 shows a Django Admin screen that lists all of the `Musician` objects in the database. The code I wrote to generate that screen is less than 80 lines long. With it, you have multifield sorting, field search, filtering, custom columns, and all the actions you need to be able to add, update, and delete musicians from the database.

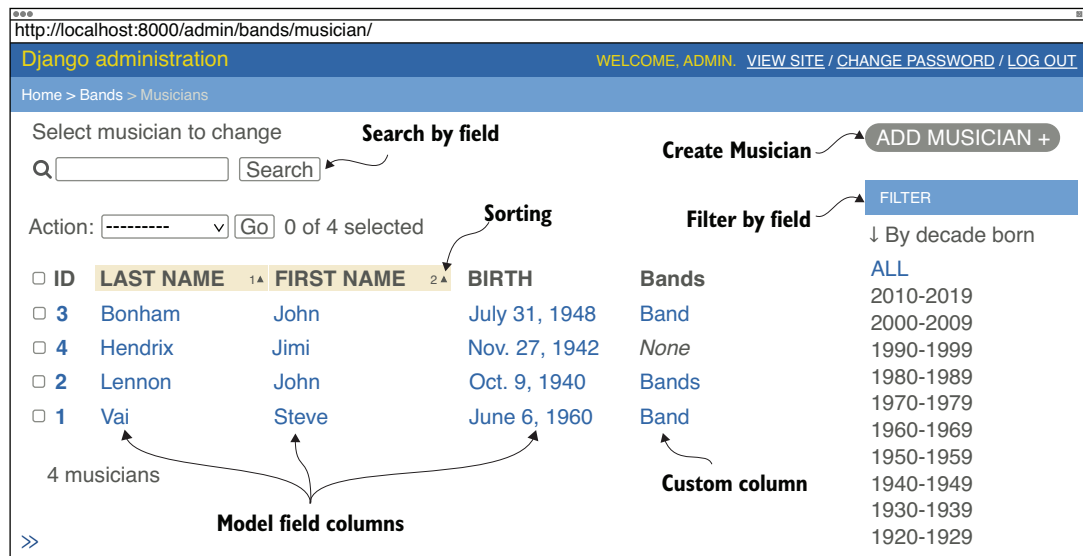


Figure 5.1 Parts of the Musician Listing page in the Django Admin

As the name implies, the Django Admin's purpose is administering your website. Its interface isn't the prettiest, and its design is optimized for users who control your site. Before using the Django Admin, you need to understand the basics of user permissions. Django is a multiuser framework, meaning you can create websites that have user accounts, and each account can be restricted to a subset of activities. Django has fine-grained permission control, and you can get quite specific about who can do what, but it also has a high-level mechanism that is good enough for most situations. Django divides users into three classes:

- General users
- Staff
- Admins

So far, when visiting RiffMates, you've been acting as an anonymous general user: one who isn't logged in. All the pages you've built have been public, so all users, including anonymous ones, are allowed to visit them. You'll learn all about building pages with restrictions in a later chapter.